Twitter, Facebook, mobile dial-ins and WhatsApp. From thirty seconds to thirty minutes, separate videos were created depending on the platform. ‘This was multimedia carpet-bombing,’ Gupta told me.

Fascinated by the power of the Internet, Modi would sometimes attend the meetings of the technology team. ‘He’s a great listener. He’d see the presentations, give us his inputs and then leave us to execute,’ is how one Team Modi member described the exercise. There was, they insist, very little attempt made by the BJP’s prime ministerial candidate to micromanage the campaign at any stage.

As in the case with television, it would be an exaggeration to suggest the digital offensive won Modi the 2014 election. It was, at best, a force multiplier. Several parts of rural India in particular still aren’t connected to the Net revolution. But when you look at the millions who now use smartphones—the Internet and mobile association claims that mobile Internet users had touched 185 million by mid-2014—there is little doubt that digital media can no longer be ignored in any future election campaign plan.

Indeed, the Internet blitz was another crucial piece in the reinvention of Modi. For example, by building a large and devout Twitter following, Modi was able to challenge the monopoly of the traditional media on opinion making. Modi was always convinced that a large section of the English-language media would never make him forget the 2002 riots. Now, thousands of handles on Twitter systematically attacked any narrative that challenged Modi in particular and the BJP in general. Journalists increasingly tend to follow Twitter like a wire service and watching social media trends has become part of a reporter’s duties. Thus, by sheer force of numbers, Team Modi wielded social media’s power over mainstream media’s news priorities. On Facebook, too, he was able to connect to a wide urban audience that was looking for a leader they could engage with. It became another vital platform to spread his ideas effectively (13 million people made 75 million Modi-related interactions during the two election months on Facebook).